

MMEMME

MMEMME = a trust-first marketplace for Nigerian celebrations: discover → compare → message → book → pay → review, plus a staff "gigs" board for ushers/assistants/stewards.

The "North Star" metric is **completed bookings** (not installs, not signups).

And the flywheel you already described is correct: **bookings** → **reviews** → **trust** → **more users** → **more vendors** → **better selection** → **more bookings**.

This matters because everything (brand, UX, verification, payment flow, disputes) must be designed to increase:

1. inquiry→booking conversion,
- 2) booking completion rate,
- 3) review rate,
- 4) repeat booking.

PART A — STARTUP LIFECYCLE (IDEATION → LAUNCH → GROWTH)

1) Founder alignment & operating agreement

Lock these early so we don't destroy the company later:

A. Roles & ownership

- Founder roles: CEO/Business vs CTO/Co-founder vs any other cofounders.
- Equity split + vesting (typical: 4-year vesting, 1-year cliff).
- Decision rights: product scope, hiring, spending limits, investor sign-off.
- IP assignment: all work created belongs to the company.

B. Company basics

- Company name availability + domain acquisition
- Incorporation structure (local Nigerian entity vs Delaware + Nigerian subsidiary later)
- Banking: business account, payment gateways account ownership

Deliverable: Founder agreement + vesting + cap table draft (simple is fine at this stage).

2) Market validation & positioning

Even though the idea is clear, we still have to validate "willingness to use & pay" in Nigeria (and diaspora).

A. Define beachhead (launch wedge)

Do NOT launch "all events, all vendors, all cities" on day 1.

Pick one wedge like:

- **Lagos weddings** (traditional + church) OR
- **Abuja weddings** OR
- "Detty December" high-velocity bookings for **car rentals + event halls + caterers**

The MVP categories we identified are perfect for wedge launch: venues, planners, caterers, car rentals, jobs.

B. Pre-launch interviews (structured)

We already have use cases; now validate pricing + trust barriers:

- 25 celebrants (recently married or planning)
- 25 vendors (top + mid-tier)
- 15 job seekers (ushers/staff)
- 10 planners (who coordinate many vendors)

Collect:

- common cancellation patterns
- booking lead time distribution
- typical deposits
- what they consider "verified"
- payment preferences (card/transfer)
- what causes disputes

C. Competitive map

Instagram/WhatsApp is our real competitor. Our differentiation must be:

- verified listings + reviews
- standardized booking + deposit
- availability
- dispute handling / refunds
- speed & convenience

Deliverables:

- 1-page "Why MMEMME wins" positioning
- launch wedge decision
- pricing hypothesis

3) Business model & unit economics

We already propose: commission and/or vendor subscription options.

A. Choose a monetization model for MVP

Start with the simplest that drives adoption:

- **Commission on completed bookings** (works immediately)
- Optional: **vendor subscription** for boosted listing or lower commission (later)

You already sketched commissions by category and subscription tiers (as rules).

B. Define "take rate" and payout mechanics

- When do you take your commission? (at deposit, at completion, or split)
- When do vendors receive payout? (immediate vs delayed)
- Refund & cancellation policy clarity (must be visible before payment)

C. Marketplace health metrics (must track from day 1)

- Demand: searches, inquiries, inquiry→booking
- Supply: vendor signups, approval rate, response rate, completion rate
- Trust: disputes per 100 bookings, average rating, repeat rate
- Liquidity: time-to-first-booking for new vendors

Deliverable: Unit economics sheet (even rough) + pricing page draft.

4) Brand & product identity

We need brand clarity *before* UI design is finalized.

A. Brand foundation

- Brand promise: "Make your owambe stress-free"
- Values: trust, reliability, celebration, transparency
- Tone: modern Nigerian, warm, credible (not gimmicky)
- Key message pillars:
 1. Verified vendors & reviews
 2. Compare prices & packages
 3. Book and pay safely
 4. Hire staff easily

B. Naming & tagline

The mmemme doc you gave me already proposes tagline options and logo direction prompts.

C. Visual identity system (minimum)

- Logo + icon + wordmark
- Color palette (accessible)
- Typography
- UI components style
- Photography guidelines (vendors' portfolios look consistent)

D. Brand assets needed for launch

- Landing page
- App store screenshots & preview copy
- Social templates (IG, TikTok)
- Vendor onboarding deck (PDF)
- Press kit (logo pack, product screenshots, founder bio)

Team expertise needed:

- Brand designer (identity + UI direction)
- Copywriter (product messaging, onboarding)
- UI/UX designer (mobile + admin web)

5) Legal, trust, safety & policy

This type of marketplace lives or dies on trust.

A. Core policies (must exist by MVP)

- Vendor approval criteria + verification steps
- Review policy: what gets removed vs not (and moderation screens exist)
- Cancellation/refund policy (deposit, time windows)
- Dispute resolution process (how evidence is submitted, timelines)
- Job no-show policy & penalties (your rules already anticipate this)

B. Terms & agreements

We need separate agreements:

- User Terms (celebrants)
- Vendor Terms (service quality, cancellation, payouts, dispute process)
- Worker Terms (job-seekers)
- Privacy Policy
- Payment/Refund policy

C. Fraud & safety plan (Nigeria reality)

- Fake vendors, stolen photos, advance-fee scams, identity spoofing
- Minimal mitigations for MVP:
 - vendor approval queue
 - reporting/flagging flow
 - response-rate and cancellation-rate ranking penalties
 - optional: require deposits only through platform (discourage "pay outside")

6) Go-to-market (GTM) and operations

Our marketplace needs **supply first**. If celebrants arrive and see emptiness, we lose.

A. Supply acquisition plan (vendors)

- Pick 2 cities first (e.g., Lagos + Abuja)
- Pick 5 categories for MVP (you already did)
- Target: **20–30 quality vendors per category** in beachhead city before public launch (your doc implies this scale).
- Vendor onboarding process:
 1. invite / outreach
 2. profile creation
 3. portfolio upload + pricing packages
 4. verification review
 5. "how to win on MMEMME" training (response time, photo quality, pricing clarity)

B. Demand acquisition plan (celebrants)

- Partner with planners, bridal IG pages, MCs, wedding blogs
- Referral loop: "Invite a friend planning a wedding"
- Content engine:
 - "Top 10 venues in Lekki under ₦X"
 - "Budget wedding checklist"
 - "Detty December vendor readiness"

C. Job board acquisition (workers)

- University campuses, student communities
- "Weekend ushering" ads and partnerships with event staff agencies

D. Customer support & trust ops

This is not optional:

- support chat + ticketing
- dispute handling runbook
- vendor moderation SLA (you already wrote 48-hour review SLA)

Team expertise needed:

- Vendor acquisition lead (field + partnerships)
- Community/support lead
- Ops lead (disputes + payouts + vendor verification)

7) Fundraising plan (when and how)

We may not need investors to ship MVP, but we will need them for growth, escrow, verification integrations, marketing, and team.

A. Pre-seed readiness checklist

Investors will ask:

- What wedge? What city?
- How do you acquire vendors cheaply?
- How do you prevent fraud?
- What's the take rate?
- What are your early retention signals?
- Why you vs existing IG/WhatsApp behavior?

B. Materials to prepare

- Pitch deck (10-12 slides):
 - Problem (fragmented planning)
 - Solution (one-stop marketplace)
 - Market size (Nigeria events + diaspora)
 - Product demo (screens + flow)
 - Business model (commission/subscription)
 - Go-to-market (supply first)
 - Traction (vendors onboarded, bookings)
 - Team (you as technical cofounder)
 - Roadmap (escrow, ID verification, multi-currency)
 - Ask (amount, runway, use of funds)

C. Targets

- Angels in Nigeria/diaspora
- Micro-VCs focused on Africa marketplaces
- Strategic partners (event associations, payment providers)

PART B — PRODUCT DELIVERY LIFECYCLE (ENGINEERING + DESIGN + LAUNCH)

8) Product management system (how to build without chaos)

You need structure: PRD → specs → tasks → QA → release.

A. Core product docs

- PRD (product requirement doc)
- User stories with acceptance criteria (per persona)
- Event taxonomy (wedding/birthday/etc.)
- Policies (refunds, disputes, reviews)
- Analytics plan (events you track)

B. Delivery cadence

- 2-week sprints
- weekly demo
- weekly vendor/customer interviews even while building

Expertise needed:

- Product manager (can be founder initially, but someone must own prioritization)
- Tech lead (me)

9) UX/UI design deliverables (mobile + web)

The mmmme doc you gave me already sketches a huge set of screens (approx ~50 unique views). To ship MVP faster, you convert that into **MVP-only flows** and design those first.

A. Design phases

1. **Information architecture** (nav, account switching)
2. **MVP user flows**
3. **Wireframes**
4. **High-fidelity UI**
5. **Design system** (components)
6. **Prototype testing** with 5-10 users

B. MVP flows to design first

- Onboarding & account type selection
- Vendor browsing + filters
- Vendor profile + packages + availability
- Messaging

- Booking request → acceptance → payment → confirmation
- Reviews
- Job board (post job, apply, hire, attendance)
- Admin web (vendor approval, disputes, review moderation)

C. Non-negotiables for Nigerian context

- Low-data mode
- "Continue as guest" browsing
- Fast search
- WhatsApp-friendly sharing (link vendor profile)
- Clear deposit and cancellation terms before payment

Expertise needed:

- Senior product designer (mobile marketplace experience)
- UX researcher (even part-time)

PART C — ENGINEERING SYSTEM (MOBILE + WEB + BACKEND + INFRA)

10) Architecture decision: what apps you actually build

We will build **three primary surfaces**:

1. **Mobile app** (iOS + Android) for celebrants, vendors, job seekers, job listers
2. **Web admin dashboard** (for platform admins)
3. **Backend API** + database + storage + messaging/notifications

Optional:

- Marketing website/landing page (web)
- Vendor web portal (later) if vendors prefer desktop

11) Recommended tech stack (reliable, fast-to-ship)

Mobile

- **Flutter** (fastest to ship cross-platform) OR React Native
- Push notifications: Firebase Cloud Messaging
- Deep links: for booking and vendor profile links

Web (Admin)

- Next.js/React (or similar)
- Role-based admin access, audit logs

Backend

- Node.js (NestJS) or Python (Django/DRF) – pick what you can ship fastest with quality
- REST (start) + maybe GraphQL later
- Background jobs: BullMQ/Celery
- Realtime chat: WebSockets or a managed chat service (but you'll likely build lightweight chat first)

Data

- PostgreSQL (transactions)
- Redis (caching, sessions, rate-limits)
- Object storage (S3-compatible) for portfolios, documents

Payments

- Paystack/Flutterwave integration (MVP)
- Webhooks (critical)
- Escrow later (V2)

12) Core backend domains (the "system components")

A. Identity & access

- Account types: celebrant, vendor, job seeker, job lister, admin
- Phone + email verification flow
- Permissions (RBAC): who can do what
- Account switching (some users may be vendor + job lister)

B. Vendor listing system

- Vendor profiles, categories, service areas
- Pricing packages
- Portfolio uploads (images/video)
- Availability calendar
- Verification status + badges (MVP: "pending/approved/rejected")
- Ranking signals: rating, response rate, etc. (you described this logic)

C. Search & discovery

- Full-text search + filters:
 - location, date availability, price range, rating
- Sort: recommended/top rated/price
- "Favorites/shortlist" (if MVP includes)

D. Booking engine (the heart)

You already defined the core status model and timing rules.

Implement:

- Booking states: Inquiry → Pending → Confirmed → Completed → Reviewed (+ Cancelled/Disputed)
- Vendor acceptance window
- Deposit rules and deadlines
- Balance payment reminders
- Calendar locking to prevent double booking

E. Payments & payouts

- Initiate payment, confirm via webhook
- Ledger for:
 - gross amount
 - platform fee
 - vendor net
 - refund amounts
- Receipts
- Payout workflow:
 - MVP: manual payout + export report for finance
 - Later: automated transfers

F. Messaging (in-app chat)

- Conversation threads tied to booking/job
- Attachments (images)
- Moderation access for admin during disputes (with privacy policy clarity)

G. Reviews & reputation

- Review tied to verified booking (prevents fake reviews)
- Review moderation queue
- Vendor response to reviews (you described this scenario)

H. Job marketplace

- Post job listings
- Apply
- Hire workflow
- Attendance / "no-show" actions
- Worker payments & ratings

I. Admin platform (must exist for launch)

Your admin feature set is already strong: dashboard metrics, vendor approval queue, user management, dispute management, review moderation.

Minimum admin capabilities for MVP:

- Approve/reject vendors with reason
- Suspend/ban users
- Refund processing (at least recording + initiating)
- Review moderation actions
- Dispute resolution workflow

J. Notifications service

Events to notify (critical):

- new inquiry, booking accepted, payment success/fail
 - reminders (balance due, event upcoming)
 - job application accepted, event reminders
- You already described key triggers and channels (push/email/sms).

13) Data model & integrity

You wrote a full data model in the mmemme doc you gave me (Users, VendorProfile, AvailabilityCalendar, Booking, Transactions, Reviews, Jobs, Applications, Messages, Disputes, Admin audit logs, etc.). That's exactly what our DataBase tables should reflect.

Non-negotiables:

- immutable transaction records
- immutable booking audit trail
- admin action log (for internal accountability)
- strict foreign keys and status transitions (avoid "impossible states")

14) Infrastructure & DevOps (do this properly or you'll regret it)

Environments

- Dev, Staging, Production
- Separate databases and storage buckets
- Feature flags (turn features on/off)

Hosting

- Backend: containerized (Docker)
- Managed DB (Postgres)
- Object storage (S3-compatible)
- CDN for images (fast portfolios)

Security baseline

- HTTPS everywhere
- Password hashing
- Rate limiting (login, OTP)
- Webhook signature verification (payments)
- Role-based access checks for every endpoint
- Sensitive document encryption (if you store vendor verification docs)

Observability

- Error tracking (Sentry)
- Logs (structured logs, searchable)

- Monitoring (uptime, latency)
- Audit logs for admin actions

Backups & disaster recovery

- Daily DB backups, point-in-time recovery
- Storage versioning for critical documents

Expertise needed:

- DevOps/Cloud engineer (can be part-time early)
- Security-minded backend engineer

15) QA, testing, and release engineering (how you ship without embarrassment)

QA types you need

- Functional testing of all core flows
- Payment testing (success/fail/refund)
- Webhook edge cases (double webhook, delayed webhook)
- Device testing (low-end Android phones common in Nigeria)
- Network instability testing (2G/3G, offline)
- Abuse testing (spam messages, fake reviews, vendor scams)

Test automation (minimum)

- Backend: unit + integration tests
- Critical e2e tests (booking + payment)
- Admin actions tests (approve vendor, refund)

Beta program

- Closed beta: 50 vendors + 200 celebrants
- City-limited
- Weekly feedback loops

PART D — TEAM & EXPERTISE (WHO WE NEED)

16) The "flawless execution" team map

Core founding team (minimum)

1. CEO / Business lead

- vendor partnerships, investor relations, pricing, GTM

2. CTO / Technical cofounder

- architecture, delivery, hiring engineers, security baseline

Product & design

3. Product designer (senior)

- marketplace UX, mobile-first, admin UX

4. Product manager (can be founder early)

- prioritization, roadmap, acceptance criteria

Engineering

5. Backend engineer

- booking system, payments, messaging, admin APIs

6. Mobile engineer

- Flutter/RN build, notifications, offline caching

7. Frontend web engineer

- admin dashboard, analytics views, moderation tools

8. QA engineer

- test plans, regression testing, release gating

9. DevOps/Cloud engineer (part-time ok early)

- CI/CD, environments, monitoring, scaling

Operations (absolutely required for marketplace trust)

10. **Vendor onboarding/verification lead**

- approve vendors, quality control, anti-fraud

11. **Support & disputes**

- dispute resolution workflow, refunds, SLAs

Growth

12. **Marketing/Growth**

- content, partnerships, referrals, city launch playbook

PART E — EXECUTION ROADMAP (A REALISTIC BUILD-TO-LAUNCH PLAN)

17) Phase-by-phase build plan

Phase 1 — Pre-build

- Lock beachhead city + categories
- Branding foundations + landing page
- Vendor acquisition pipeline begins NOW
- Build PRD + MVP scope
- Figma wireframes for MVP flows

Phase 2 — MVP build

Ship only what creates completed bookings:

MVP must-haves (from your mmemme doc):

- multi-role accounts + profiles
- vendor listings + packages + availability
- search + filter
- inquiry + messaging
- booking flow + payment integration (Paystack/Flutterwave)
- reviews
- job board basics
- admin dashboard for approvals, moderation, disputes
- push notifications

Phase 3 – Beta & trust hardening

- closed beta in one city
- tighten cancellations & dispute flow
- improve ranking and vendor response rate
- refine pricing display and package clarity

Phase 4 – Public launch

- launch PR + influencer partnerships
- app store optimization
- vendor “featured” promotions
- support runbooks live

Phase 5 – V2 expansion (ongoing)

Your V2 list is strong: escrow, deeper verification, planner tools, promoted listings, analytics.
Prioritize:

1. escrow (trust)
2. better verification (trust)
3. vendor analytics + promoted listings (revenue)

PART F – LAUNCH CHECKLIST (NO SURPRISES)

18) Pre-launch operational readiness

- 100+ verified vendors in beachhead city (minimum)
- support SLA defined (e.g., dispute response < 24h)
- refund process tested end-to-end
- admin moderation staffed
- analytics dashboards working
- incident plan (what if payments fail? what if scam report goes viral?)

19) Launch assets

- website + FAQ
- onboarding emails/SMS templates

- app store listing copy + screenshots
 - vendor onboarding PDF
 - "How MMEMME works" explainer video
-